

First woman space tourist	Anousheh Ansari (<i>Irani American</i>)
First woman to reach the North pole	Frances Phipps
First woman to set foot on the North pole	Ann Bancroft, USA
First woman to reach Antarctica	Caroline Michaelson
First woman to climb Mount Everest	Junko Tabei (<i>Japan</i>)
First woman in the world to cross the Strait of Gibralter	Sophie Psilolignou (<i>Greek</i>)
First woman to chair US Central Bank 'Federal Reserve'	Janet Yellen
First UN Deputy Secretary-General	Louise Frechette (<i>Canada</i>)

First in World (Miscellaneous)

First city to be attacked with atom bomb	Hiroshima (Japan)
First country to launch satellite into space	Russia (former USSR)
First country to host the modern Olympic Games	Greece
First religion of the world	Sanatan Dharma
First country to print books	China
First country to issue paper currency	China
First country to start civil services competition	China
First country to make education compulsory	Prussia
First country to win the World Cup Football	Uruguay (1930)
First country to make a Constitution	United States of America
First country to launch satellite into space	Russia
First country to host modern olympics	Greece
First space shuttle launched	Columbia
First spaceship landed on Moon	Viking-1
First university of the world	Taxila University

First in India

First in India (Male)

First mountaineer to climb the Mount Everest 10 times	Ang Rita Sherpa
First Chairman of National Human Rights Commission	Rangnath Mishra
First Chief Justice of India	Hiralal J Kania
First Muslim President of Indian National Congress	Badruddin Tayyabji
First Muslim President of India	Dr Zakir Hussain
First Governor General of Free India	Lord Mountbatten
First and last Indian to be Governor General of Free India	C Rajagopalachari
First Indian to receive Bharat Ratna Award	Dr Radhakrishnan
First Education Minister	Abdul Kalam Azad
First person to receive Nobel Prize in Economics	Amartya Sen
First Wax Statue of a Living Indian	Mahatma Gandhi at Madame Tussaud's in 1939

First in India (Female)

First lady to become Miss World	Reita Faria
First woman Judge in Supreme Court	Mrs Fatima Beevi
First woman Governor of a State in free India	Mrs Sarojini Naidu
First woman Prime Minister	Mrs Indira Gandhi
First woman to climb Mount Everest	Bachhendri Pal
First woman to receive Ashoka Chakra	Nirja Bhanot
First woman to receive Jnanpith Award	Ashapurna Devi
First woman to receive Nobel Prize	Mother Teresa
First woman Director General of Police	Kanchan Chaudhary Bhattacharya
First woman Lieutenant General	Puneeta Arora

First in India (Miscellaneous)

Census	1872
Regular decadal census	1881 onwards
Newspaper	Bengal Gazette
University	Nalanda University
Defence University	Indian National Defence University, Gurgaon
Bank	Bank of Hindustan
Telephone in India	1851
Telegraph line	Diamond Harbour to Calcutta
First rail line	Mumbai to Thane
First expressway	Mumbai-Pune
First metro train	Kolkata Metro
Marine National Park	Kutch
National Park	Jim Corbatt National Park
Biosphere Reserve	Nilgiri
First Stock Exchange	Bombay Stock Exchange
Silent Film	Raja Harishchandra
Talkie Movie	Aalam Ara
First Satellite	Aryabhata
First to implement Panchayati Raj	Rajasthan
First Indian in International Court of Justice	Dr Nagendra Singh
First test tube baby	Harsha (Indira)

Superlatives in World

(The Largest, Biggest, Smallest, Longest, Highest)

Airliner	Longest—Boeing 747-8
Airport	Largest—King Abdul Khalid International Airport (Riyadh, Saudi Arabia) Highest—Bangda Airport, Tibet (Now in China)
Bay	Largest—Hudson Bay, Canada
Building	Tallest—Burj Khalifa, Dubai (828 m)

Continent	Smallest—Australia Largest—Asia
Coral formation	Largest—The Great Barrier Reef (Australia)
Country	Largest (in area)—Russia Highest—Tibet (The Pamirs)
	Largest (in population)—China
Day	Longest—21st June (in Northern hemisphere) Shortest—22nd December (in Northern hemisphere)
Delta	Largest—Sundarbans, India
Democracy	Largest—India
Desert	Largest—Sahara, Africa
Gulf	Longest—Gulf of Mexico
Island	Largest—Greenland (renamed Kalaallit Nunaat)
Lake	Deepest—Baikal (Siberia) Highest—Titicaca (Bolivia) Largest (Fresh Water)—Lake Superior, USA Largest (Artificial)—Lake Mead (Boulder)
Minar (Free standing)	Tallest—Qutub Minar, Delhi (238 ft)
Mosque	Largest Masjid—al-Haram, Saudi Arabia
Mountain Peak (World)	Highest—Mt Everest (Nepal), Himalayas
Mountain Range	Longest—Andes S America
Ocean	Deepest and Biggest—The Pacific
Peninsula	Largest—Arabia
Place	Coldest—Oymyakon (Russia) Temperature -58°F. Hottest—Al-Aziziyah (Libya, Africa) 136°F Driest—Mc Murdo Dry Valleys, Antarctica
River	Longest—Nile (6690 km) Largest (Basin)—Amazon Basin
Sea (Inland)	Largest—Mediterranean
Statue	Tallest—Spring Temple Buddha, China
Tunnel	Longest and Largest (Canal)—Le Rove Tunnel (South of France) Longest (Railway)—Gotthard Base Tunnel (Switzerland)
Volcano	Largest—Mauna Loa (Hawaii) Highest—Ojos del Salado, Andes, Argentine-Chile (6885 m)
Waterfall	Highest—Salto Angel Falls (Venezuela)
World's Rainiest Spot	Mawsynram (Meghalaya, India)

Superlatives in India

(Biggest, Highest, Largest, Longest, Smallest etc.)

The longest River	The Ganga (2640 km)
The longest Canal	Indira Gandhi Canal or Rajasthan Canal (Rajasthan)
The longest Dam	Hirakud Dam (Odisha)
The largest Lake	Wular Lake (Jammu and Kashmir)
The highest Dam	Tehri Dam on Bhagirathi River
The highest Waterfall	Kunchikal (Karnataka)
The State with longest Coastline	Gujarat
The longest Sea Bridge	Bandra-Worli sea link

The longest Road	NH-44 (Srinagar to Kanya Kumari)
The highest Road	Road at Khardungla (in Leh-Manali Sector)
The highest Airport	Leh Airport (Ladakh)
The largest Desert	Thar (Rajasthan)
The largest Delta	Sunderbans (Paschim Banga)
The largest Zoo	Zoological Garden (Kolkata)
The tallest TV Tower	Rameswaram Tower, Tamil Nadu
The highest Peak	Godwin Austin, K-2 (8611 m)
The largest Mosque	Jama Masjid (Delhi)
The tallest Statue	Gomateswara (Karnataka)
The oldest Church	St Thomas Church at Palayur, Trichur (Kerala)
The biggest Church	Saint Cathedral at Old Goa (Goa)
The longest Beach	Mariana Beach, Chennai
The largest Dome	Gol Gumbaz (Bizapur, Karnataka)
The heaviest Rainfall	Mawsynram (Meghalaya)
The oldest Refinery	Digboi (Assam)
The longest Glacier	Siachen Glacier (Indo-Pak Border)
Most populous city	Mumbai (Maharashtra)
The fastest Train	Gatimaan Express (Delhi-Agra)
The largest Cave Temple	Ellora Temples (Aurangabad, Maharashtra)
The largest concentration of Scheduled Tribes	Madhya Pradesh
The largest concentration of Scheduled Caste Population	Uttar Pradesh
The largest Plateau	Deccan Plateau
The largest Public Sector Bank	State Bank of India

Countries with Capitals, Currencies and Languages

<i>Country</i>	<i>Capital(s)</i>	<i>Currency</i>	<i>Primary Language(s)</i>
Afghanistan	Kabul	Afghani	Dari Persian; Pashto
Albania	Tirane	Lek	Albanian
Algeria	Algiers	Algerian Dinar	Arabic; Tamazight; French
Angola	Luanda	Kwanza	Portuguese
Argentina	Buenos Aires	Argentine Peso	Spanish
Australia	Canberra	Australian Dollar	English
Austria	Vienna	Euro	German
Bahrain	Manama	Bahraini Dinar	Arabic
Bangladesh	Dhaka	Taka	Bangla
Belgium	Brussels	Euro	Dutch; French; German
Bhutan	Thimphu	Ngultrum	Dzongkha
Cambodia	Phnom Penh	Riel	Khmer
Canada	Ottawa	Canadian Dollar	English; French
Chile	Santiago	Chilean Peso	Spanish
China	Beijing	Chinese Yuan	Mandarin

<i>Country</i>	<i>Capital(s)</i>	<i>Currency</i>	<i>Primary Language(s)</i>
Democratic Republic of the Congo	Kinshasa	Congolese Franc	French
Cyprus	Nicosia	Euro	Greek; Turkish
Denmark	Copenhagen	Danish Krone	Danish
Egypt	Cairo	Egyptian Pound	Arabic
Ethiopia	Addis Ababa	Birr	Amharic
France	Paris	Euro; CFP Franc	French
Germany	Berlin	Euro	German
Ghana	Accra	Ghanaian Cedi	English
Greece	Athens	Euro	Greek
India	New Delhi	Indian Rupee	Hindi; English
Indonesia	Jakarta	Rupiah	Indonesian
Iran	Tehran	Rial	Persian
Iraq	Baghdad	Iraqi Dinar	Arabic; Kurdish
Japan	Tokyo	Yen	Japanese
Jordan	Amman	Jordanian Dinar	Arabic
Kazakhstan	Astana	Tenge	Kazakh; Russian
Kenya	Nairobi	Kenyan Shilling	Swahili; English
Libya	Tripoli	Libyan Dinar	Arabic
Malaysia	Kuala Lumpur	Ringgit	Malay
Mali	Bamako	West African CFA Franc	French
Mauritius	Port Louis	Mauritian Rupee	English
Mongolia	Ulaanbaatar	Togrog	Mongolian
Mexico	Mexico City	Mexican Peso	Spanish
Myanmar (Burma)	Naypyidaw	Kyat	Burmese
Nepal	Kathmandu	Nepalese Rupee	Nepali
New Zealand	Wellington	New Zealand Dollar	English
North Korea	Pyongyang	North Korean Won	Korean
Norway	Oslo	Norwegian Krone	Norwegian
Pakistan	Islamabad	Pakistani Rupee	Urdu; English
Philippines	Manila	Phillipine Peso	Filipino; English
Poland	Warsaw	Zloty	Polish
Portugal	Lisbon	Euro	Portuguese
Qatar	Doha	Qatari Riyal	Arabic
Russia	Moscow	Ruble	Russian
Saudi Arabia	Riyadh	Saudi Riyal	Arabic
Singapore	Singapore	Singapore Dollar	English; Malay; Mandarin Chinese
South Korea	Seoul	South Korean Won	Korean
South Africa	Pretoria; Cape Town; Bloemfontein	Rand	Zulu; Xhosa; Afrikaans
Sri Lanka	Colombo	Sri Lankan Rupee	Sinhala; Tamil
Sudan	Khartoum	Sudanese Pound	Arabic; English

<i>Country</i>	<i>Capital(s)</i>	<i>Currency</i>	<i>Primary Language(s)</i>
Syria	Damascus	Syrian Pound	Arabic
Thailand	Bangkok	Thai Baht	Thai
Uganda	Kampala	Uganda Shilling	Swahili; English
United Kingdom	London	Pound Sterling	English
Ukraine	Kiev	Hryvnia	Ukranian; Russian
United States of America	Washington DC	United States Dollar	English; Spanish
United Arab Emirates	Abu Dhabi	Dirham	Arabic
Vatican City	Vatican City	Euro	Latin; Italian
Vietnam	Hanoi	Dong	Vietnamese
Venezuela	Caracas	Bolivar Fuerte	Spanish
Zimbabwe	Harare	United States Dollar	English

National Emblem of Major Countries

<i>Country</i>	<i>Emblem</i>	<i>Country</i>	<i>Emblem</i>
Australia	Kangaroo		
Bangladesh	Water Lily	Israel	Candelabrum
Belgium	Lion	Italy	White Lily
Canada	White Lily, Maple Leaf	Japan	Chrysanthemum
Chile	Candor and Huemul	Netherlands	Lion
Denmark	Beach	New Zealand	Southern Cross, Kiwi, Fern
France	Lily	Norway	Lion
Germany	Corn Flower	Pakistan	Crescent and Star
India	Lion Capital	Spain	Eagle
Iran	Rose	UK	Rose
Ireland	The Harp	USA	Golden Rod

Principal Languages of India

India is home to several hundred languages. The Constitution of India recognises 22 languages.

<i>Language</i>	<i>Region</i>
Assamese	Assam
Bengali	West Bengal
Bodo	North-East States
Dogri	Himachal Pradesh, Jammu
Gujarati	Gujarat
Hindi	Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, especially in Northern part of India.
Kannada	Karnataka
Kashmiri	Jammu & Kashmir
Konkani	Goa
Malayalam	Kerala

Language	Region
Manipuri	Manipur
Maithili	Mithilanchal (Bihar)
Marathi	Maharashtra
Nepali	Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam
Oriya/Odia	Odisha
Punjabi	Punjab
Sanskrit	Earliest language in India
Santhali	Chotanagpur Plateau
Sindhi	Indo-Aryan language
Tamil	Tamil Nadu
Telugu	Andhra Pradesh
Urdu	Jammu & Kashmir, Uttar Pradesh

Places Related to Famous Personalities

Place	Personality
Chittor (Haldighati)	Maharana Pratap
Lumbini, Kushinagar, Kapilvastu	Gautam Buddha
Porbandar, Sabarmati, Sewagram	Mahatma Gandhi
Shanti Niketan	Rabindranath Thakur (Tagore)
Talwandi	Guru Nanak
Pavapuri, Kundagram	Mahavir Swami
Fatehpur Sikri	Akbar
Puducherry	Arvind Ghosh
Anaudvan	Baba Amte
Belur Math	Ramkrishna Paramhans
Pavrar	Vinoba Bhave
Srirangpattnam	Tipu Sultan
Jiradei	Dr Rajendra Prasad
Cuttak	Subhashchandra Bose
Trimurti Bhavan, Anand Bhavan	Jawaharlal Nehru
Bardoli	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

Great Foundations and their Founders

Foundation	Founder
Kashi Hindu Vishwavidyalaya (1916)	Pandit Madanmohan Malviya
Shanti Niketan	Ravindranath Tagore
Swaraj Party (1923)	CR Das and Motilal Nehru
Indian Association (1876)	Surendranath Banerjee and Anand Mohan Bose
Theosophical Society (1875)	Madam Blavatsky
Asiatic Society (1884)	William Jones
Indian National Congress (1885)	AO Hume
Ramkrishna Mission (1897)	Swami Vivekananda
Prarthana Samaj (1867)	Aatmaram Pandurang
Tatvabodhini Sabha	Devendranath Tagore
Harijan Sewak Sangh (1932)	Mahatma Gandhi

Crematorium of Famous Persons

Crematorium	Person	Crematorium	Person
Samata Sthal	Jagjeevan Ram	Veer Bhumi	Rajiv Gandhi
Karma Bhumi	Dr Shankar Dayal Sharma	Ekta Sthal	Giani Zail Singh, Chandra Shekhar
Mahaprayan Ghat	Dr Rajendra Prasad	Uday Bhoomi	KR Narayanan
Raj Ghat	Mahatma Gandhi	Shanti Van	Jawaharlal Nehru
Vijay Ghat	Lal Bahadur Shastri	Shakti Sthal	Indira Gandhi
Kishan Ghat	Chaudhary Charan Singh	Abhay Ghat	Morarji Desai

State and Folk Dances

Andhra Pradesh	Kuchipudi, Ghantamardala, Ottam Thedal, Siddhi Madhuri
Assam	Bihu, Bichhua, Maharas, Kaligopal, Naga dance, Khel Gopal, Tabal Chongli, Jhumura Hobjanai
Arunachal Pradesh	Mask dance, Wardance
Bihar	Jata-Jatin, Bakho-Bakhain, Panwariya, Sama-Chakwa, Bidesia
Chhattisgarh	Goudi, Karma, Jhumar, Dagia, Navrani, Mundari, Tapeli, Pali
Gujarat	Garba, Dandiya Ras, Juriun
Goa	Mandi, Jhagor, Khol, Dakni etc
Haryana	Jhumar, Phag, Daph, Dhamal, Loor, Khor
Himachal Pradesh	Jhora, Jhali, Dhaman, Chhapeli, Nati, Dangi, Stick dance
Jammu & Kashmir	Rauf, Hikar, Kud Dandi Nach, Damali
Jharkhand	Chhau, Sarhul, Karma, Sohrai, Bidesia
Karnataka	Yakshagan, Suggi, Kunittha, Karga, Lambi
Kerala	Kathakali (Classical), Ottam Thulal, Mohiniattam
Maharashtra	Lavani, Nakata, Koli, Lezim, Gafa, Dahikala Dasavtar or Bohada, Tamasha, Gouricha
Meghalaya	Laho, Baagia
Manipur	Manipuri, Rakhai, Nat Rash, Maha Rash, Riukhat etc
Mizoram	Khanatm, Pakhupila, Cherokan
Nagaland	Chong, Khaiva, Lim, Nuralim
Odisha	Odissi (Classical), Savari, Ghumara, Painka, Munari, Chhau
West Bengal	Kathi, Gambhira, Dhali, Jatra, Baul, Mahal, Keertan etc
Punjab	Bhangra, Giddha, Daff, Dhaman etc
Rajasthan	Ghumar, Chakri, Ganagor, Jhulan Leela, Jhuma, Ghapal, Kalbeliya
Tamil Nadu	Bharatnatyam, Kumi, Kolattam
Telangana	Perini Sivatandavan or Perini Thandavan
Uttar Pradesh	Nautanki, Raslila, Kajri, Jhora, Chappeli
Uttarakhand	Garhwali, Kumayuni, Kajari, Jhora, Raslila, Chappeli

Indian Authors and their Books

Writers	Books
Dr APJ Abdul Kalam	Ignited Minds, Inspiring Thoughts, You are Born to Blossom, Envisioning an Empowered Nation, Turning Points (2012), India 2020 : A Vision for the New Millennium, Target 3 Billion, The Family and the Nation (2008), Wings of Fire (<i>Autobiography</i>), Evolution of Enlightened Societies, Transcendence : My Spiritual Experience with Swami Ji
Jawaharlal Nehru	A Bunch of Old Letters, Glimpses of World History, Letters from Father to his Daughter, The Discovery of India
Indira Gandhi	My Truth, On People and Problems
Dr Hamid Ansari	Travelling through Conflict, Citizen and Society
Narendra Modi	Jyoti Punj (<i>Hindi</i>), Sakshi Bhaav (<i>Hindi</i>), Social Harmony (<i>English</i>), Convenient Action to Climate Change (<i>English</i>)
Pranab Mukherjee	The Dramatic Decade: The Indira Gandhi Years, The Turbulent Years (1980-1996) Vol-II, Thought and Reflection
Dr Rajendra Prasad	India Divided, Idea of a Nation
Sarvapalli Radha Krishnan	The Philosophy of Rabindranath Tagore, Indian Philosophy, The Hindu View of Life, Religion and Society, Recovery of Faith
Aurobindo Ghosh	Life Divine, Essays on Gita
BR Ambedkar	Annihilation of Caste, What Congress and Gandhi have Done to Untouchables
Dada Bhai Naoroji	Poverty and Un-British Rule in India
Jyotiba Phule	Gulamgiri
JP Narayan	Prison Diary
Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan	Pakhtoon
Sarojini Naidu	The Feather of Dawn, Broken Wing, Golden Threshold
Lala Lajpat Rai	Unhappy India
Mahatma Gandhi	My Experiment with Truth, Hind Swaraj, Pathway to God, India of My Dreams
Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Percept of Jesus, Mirat-ul Akbar
Shashi Tharoor	Bookless in Bagdad, Show business, India Shastra, The Elephant, Packs Indica, Great Indian Novel
Subhash Chandra Bose	The Indian Struggle
VD Savarkar	Indian War of Independence
Amartya Sen	Development as Freedom, The Idea of Justice, The Argumentative Indians, Rationality and Freedom, Inequality Re-examined, Commodities and Capabilities, Between the Assassination
Bankin Chandra Chathopadhyay	Anand Math Devi, Devi Chaudharani
Cyrus Mistry	Passion Flower
Dilip Kumar	The Substance and the Shadow
Khushwant Singh	The Sunset Club, Train to Pakistan, Sahibs who Loved India, To the Thinkers Prayer Book, Why I Supported the Emergency
Vimal Kumar	Sachin: Cricketer of the Century

Writers	Books
Meghnad Desai	The Rediscovery of India
Mulk Raj Anand	The Village, Untouchable, Confession of a Lover, Seven Summers, Two Leaves and a Bud, Coolie
Ruskin Bond	Our Tree Still Grow in Dehra, The Blue Umbrella
Rabindranath Tagore	Gitanjali, Gora, Dak Ghar, Raja
Kailash Satyarthi	Azad Bachpan Ki Aur
TS Sudhir	Saina Nehwal: An Inspirational Biography
Kiran Desai	The Inheritance of Loss, Hullabaloo in the Guava Orchard
Anita Desai	Fire on the Mountain, The Zig Zag Way
Mahasweta Devi	Rudaali, Hazaar Chaurasi Ki Maa
Annie Besant	Wake up India, An Introduction to Yoga, The Case for India, My Path of Atheism
Chetan Bhagat	Revolution 2020, What India Wants, Half Girlfriend, Making India Awesome, One Indian Girl
Shobhaa De	Second Thoughts, Superstar India : From Incredible to Unstoppable, Sweet Sixteen
Mother Teresa	Down Memory Lane
Shobha Narayanan	Return to India
Milkha Singh	The Race of My Life
Luis Suarez	Crossing the Line
Kapil Dev	Straight from the Heart
PT Usha	Golden Girl
Saina Nehwal	Playing to Win
MC Mary Kom	Unbreakable
Salman Rushdie	Midnight's Children, Two Years Eight Months and Twenty-Eight Nights, Shame, The Moor's Last Sigh, Fury, The Satanic Verses
Aravind Adiga	The White Tiger, The Last Man in Tower
Vikram Seth	A Suitable Boy, An Equal Music, Two Lives, The Golden Gate
Arundhati Roy	The God of Small Things, The Algebra of Infinite Justice
Rohinton Mistry	Such a Long Journey, Family Matters, A Fine Balance
VS Naipaul	A House for Mr Biswas, India : A Wounded Civilisation, An Area of Darkness, India : A Million Mutinies Now, The Masque of Africa, A Bend in the River
Amitav Ghosh	The Circle of Reason, Flood of Fire, River of Smoke, The Glass Palace, The Shadow Lines, The Calcutta Chromosome, The Hungry Tide, Sea of Poppies, In an Antique Land
Nayantara Sehgal	Plans for Departure, A voice of Indian
Parashar Kulkarni	Cow and Company
Jhumpa Lahiri	Namesake, The Interpreter of Maladies, The Lowland, Unaccustomed Earth
Akhil Sharma	Family Life (<i>Novel</i>)
Dilip D'souza	Ride Across the River
Nilotpal Mrinal Shandilya	Dark Horse : A Story
Chetan Bhagat	Five Point Someone, The three Mistakes of My Life, Two States, Revolution 2020